Authority Governance Standard - (AGS)

OriginID: OOF-OID-AGA-AGS-2026-06-14-0002
Architecture Ecosystem: Structured Reality Standards™
Architecture Family: Accountability Governance Architecture (AGA™)
Operational Layer: Authority Governance Layer
Governed Space: Authority Governance
Category: Governance & Enforcement
Subcategory: Accountability Governance Architecture
Type: Parent Standard
Version: 1.0
Status: Canonical · Open Standard
Origin Date: 14 June 2026
Compatibility: OOF Methodology OS · Accountability Governance Architecture (AGA™) · Relationship Accountability Standard (RAS) · Authority Validation Standard (AVS) · Authority Delegation Standard (ADS) · Authority Escalation Standard (AES) · Responsibility Governance Standard (RGS) · INTEGROS® — Integrity Standard
AI-Readable: Yes
Authority: OOF
Protection: MIP — Methodological Intellectual Property
Canonical Language: English (UCL)

Canonical Definition System

Canonical Definition

Authority Governance Standard (AGS) defines the structural conditions under which authority remains identifiable, legitimate, attributable, bounded, traceable, governable, enforceable, and operationally valid throughout operational environments.

AGS governs authority.

The standard establishes the foundational conditions required to determine who possesses the legitimate right to decide, approve, authorize, direct, restrict, supervise, intervene, delegate, escalate, or govern actions within an operational system.

Authority is the governance mechanism that grants the right to act.

Without authority, responsibility cannot be legitimately assigned and accountability cannot be reliably reconstructed.

AGS governs the integrity of authority itself.

A. Standard Abstract

Every governance system contains authority structures.

Organizations operate through authority.

Institutions operate through authority.

Governments operate through authority.

AI systems increasingly operate through authority structures.

Autonomous agents receive authority.

Orchestrated agent systems distribute authority.

Human-AI environments require authority coordination.

Before governance can determine:

- who was responsible,
- who exercised control,
- who had oversight,
- who remains accountable,

governance must first determine who possessed authority.

AGS exists to govern this condition.

B. Core Principle

Authority governance becomes valid only when authority remains identifiable, legitimate, attributable, bounded, traceable, governable, enforceable, and operationally valid throughout its lifecycle.

C. Scope

This standard may apply to:

- organizations
- institutions
- governments
- management structures
- supervisory structures
- contractor environments
- subcontractor environments
- staffing agencies
- compliance environments
- AI systems
- autonomous agents
- structured agent systems
- orchestrated agent systems
- Human-AI operational environments
- robotics ecosystems

- future intelligent operational systems

AGS applies wherever authority exists.

D. Why This Standard Exists

Modern operational environments contain increasingly
complex authority structures.

Authority may originate from:

- contracts
- employment relationships
- organizational hierarchies
- regulations
- governance systems
- operational mandates
- AI orchestration frameworks
- autonomous execution systems

In many environments authority becomes fragmented, delegated,
inherited, distributed, unclear, or disputed.

As complexity increases, governance increasingly struggles
to determine:

- who had authority
- where authority originated
- whether authority was legitimate
- whether authority exceeded its scope
- whether authority remained valid

AGS exists because governance cannot determine responsibility or
accountability until authority is understood.

E. Authority Governance Integrity Logic

Authority governance integrity exists only when the following
remain materially preservable:

1. Authority Origin Integrity

Authority remains attributable to a legitimate source.

2. Authority Scope Integrity

Authority remains bounded by clearly identifiable limits.

3. Authority Legitimacy Integrity

Authority remains valid, recognized, and governable.

4. Authority Continuity Integrity

Authority remains traceable throughout transfer, delegation, escalation, succession, or operational change.

5. Authority Accountability Integrity

Authority remains connected to accountable governance structures.

F. Operational Architecture Space

AGS defines the operational architecture space for:

- authority governance
- authority identification
- authority legitimacy
- authority attribution
- authority scope governance
- authority continuity
- authority accountability
- delegated authority governance
- distributed authority governance
- Human-AI authority governance
- agent authority governance
- authority reconstruction

This space exists because authority determines who may act within a governance system.

AGS governs whether authority remains valid.

G. Difference Between Authority and Responsibility

Authority defines the legitimate right to act.

Responsibility defines the duty to act.

A person may possess authority without responsibility.

A person may possess responsibility without authority.

The two are related but not identical.

AGS governs authority.

Responsibility Governance Standard (RGS) governs responsibility.

Both are required for valid accountability reconstruction.

H. Runtime Position

AGS operates as the second foundational layer of AGA™.

It follows:

- Relationship Accountability Standard (RAS)

and precedes:

- Responsibility Governance Standard (RGS)
- Capability Readiness Governance Standard (CRGS)
- Chain of Control Standard (CCS)
- Governance Oversight Standard (GOS)
- Evidence Accountability Standard (EAS)
- Accountability Governance Standard (AGS-A)

Authority determines who may act before governance evaluates who must act.

I. Authority Governance Failure Rule

Authority governance failure occurs when authority cannot be reliably identified, validated, bounded, traced, reconstructed, or connected to legitimate governance structures.

Examples include:

- unauthorized decision-making
- hidden authority structures
- authority impersonation
- authority ambiguity
- authority scope violations
- undocumented authority transfers
- illegitimate authority claims
- governance-blind delegation

AGS exists to expose and govern these conditions.

J. Validity Logic

An authority-governance environment is valid under AGS when:

- authority remains identifiable
- authority origin remains traceable
- authority legitimacy remains verifiable
- authority scope remains visible
- authority continuity remains reconstructable
- authority accountability remains preservable

- authority decisions remain governable

An authority-governance environment becomes invalid when:

- authority origin is unknown
- legitimacy cannot be validated
- authority exceeds its scope
- authority continuity is lost
- authority cannot be reconstructed
- authority accountability disappears

K. Relationship to Other OOF Standards

AGS derives from:

- Relationship Accountability Standard (RAS)

and supports:

- Authority Validation Standard (AVS)
- Authority Delegation Standard (ADS)
- Authority Escalation Standard (AES)
- Responsibility Governance Standard (RGS)
- Capability Readiness Governance Standard (CRGS)
- Chain of Control Standard (CCS)
- Governance Oversight Standard (GOS)
- Accountability Governance Standard (AGS-A)
- Chain of Accountability Protocol (CAP™)

RAS governs relationships.

AGS governs authority operating within those relationships.

L. Foundational Principle

Authority determines who may act before governance determines who must act.

Canonical Closing Statement

Authority Governance Standard (AGS) defines the structural conditions under which authority remains identifiable, legitimate, attributable, bounded, traceable, governable, enforceable, and operationally valid throughout operational environments.

Authority is the governance mechanism that grants the right to act.

If authority cannot be identified, validated, bounded, or reconstructed, responsibility and accountability become unreliable. Authority governance therefore

becomes a foundational condition of trustworthy governance systems.

Module Architecture

→ AOIM — Authority Origin Integrity Module

→ ASIM — Authority Scope Integrity Module

→ ALIM — Authority Legitimacy Integrity Module

→ ACIM — Authority Continuity Integrity Module

→ AAIM — Authority Accountability Integrity Module

Related Documents

→ About the Authority Governance Standard - (AGS)

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